incorrect tweets in January 2021 and they eventually took him off-air, only to bring him back two weeks later.[11] The India Today group surely understands that people don't watch prime-time news on their channels because Sardesai is on the screen but that they watch Sardesai because the channel puts him on at prime time.

On 5 April, the prime minister spoke to several leaders, including his predecessor Manmohan Singh, Congress chief Sonia Gandhi and former president Pranab Mukherjee, on the situation arising out of the novel coronavirus pandemic. He also called up various leaders, including Mulayam Singh Yadav and Akhilesh Yadav of the Samajwadi Party, West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee, Odisha CM Naveen Patnaik, Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam's M.K. Stalin and Shiromani Akali Dal leader Parkash Singh Badal, former president Pratibha Patil and former prime minister H.D. Deve Gowda.

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At this point, about 400-odd cases or 30 per cent of all cases in India were linked to the jamaatis who attended the event at the Nizamuddin Markaz in March.[12] Although after NSA Doval's intervention, the Markaz itself had been vacated and the residents escorted to a quarantine centre for testing, several attendees who had gotten out before the lockdown announcement had spread all over the country. In an advisory issued by the Ministry of Home Affairs, the state governments were asked to intensify their efforts to trace these attendees as well as their contacts in an effort to contain the spread.[13] It had also come to light that most foreigners who attended the congregation had violated visa rules and they'd be blacklisted from entering the country again.[14] Unfortunately, in a scenario where most in the country were blaming the jamaat to be a super-spreader event, instances of the jamaatis misbehaving with nurses and doctors at quarantine centres were appearing in the news.[15] Natural social psychology would attribute the mounting anger in the minds of Indians to the anxiety, helplessness and fear arising out of the lockdown. However, such instances of violence on caregivers coupled with irresponsible media coverage would drive a deeper communal wedge, leaving the jamaatis ostracized. In a saddening incident widely reported in the media, at the MMG District Hospital in Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh, six quarantined jamaatis misbehaved with the doctors and